

Dear prof. Bont and dr. De Vrankrijker,

My name is Varvara Lazarenko, and I would like to express my interest in applying for a position of a PhD student in RSV education.

From the moment I discovered this position, I felt it aligned perfectly with my career aspirations to address the societal and educational aspects of life sciences. As a recent graduate of the Medical Biology master's program with a specialization in Science, Management & Innovation (SMI) from Radboud University, I am passionate about improving healthcare through sustainable innovations and initiatives that effectively meet the needs of patients and medical professionals while being cost-effective. That is why I am thrilled about this opportunity to work at the intersection of education and medicine, disseminating awareness about RSV infection and contributing to public education efforts surrounding it.

My academic background equips me with a solid foundation for this role. Having finished a bachelor's in Biology and a master's in Medical Biology, I gained extensive knowledge in the field and developed a critical understanding of various medical technologies and biomedical challenges. During the SMI track in the second year of my master's, I gained valuable insights into digital healthcare, health technology assessment (HTA), market research, value propositions, and health economics.

In addition to my academic qualifications, my professional experience will be an asset for the PhD position in Sustainable Healthcare. As a Junior Research Assistant at the Faculty of Biology and an assistant at a Contract Research Organization, I gained substantial experience in writing academic papers, designing experiments, preparing clinical documentation, and ensuring compliance with client requirements. This role deepened my understanding of the scientific and healthcare landscapes as well as improved my managerial and interpersonal skills.

My master's thesis at HAN University of Applied Sciences focused on the added value of home telemonitoring technology. It involved conducting an extensive literature review, as well as surveys and interviews with patients and medical professionals, culminating in a cost-effectiveness analysis, which provided me with valuable experience in both qualitative and quantitative methods used in social science research. Since the surveys needed to be done in Dutch, I started learning the language more actively, and I hope to speak it at least at the B2 level within a year. Furthermore, during my SMI track, I had the opportunity to work on real-world projects such as "HTA of a Medical Guidance App for International Students in the NL" and "A Shared Ownership Model of the Green Corridor." These experiences greatly enriched my understanding of stakeholder collaboration and honed my skills in presenting and engaging audiences effectively.

To sum up, my strong motivation for connecting science and society, combined with my comprehensive education and diverse professional experiences, positions me as a strong candidate for the PhD student position in RSV education. Working on this PhD project will bring me closer to my final academic and career goals – towards the future of an educational expert in connecting science and society.

Thank you for considering my application and, in case any questions arise, please do not hesitate to contact me.

Kind regards,
Varvara Lazarenko